

Developing Android Apps Using the MIT App Inventor 2

Wannabe Android app developers and developers alike will be interested in this well-illustrated tutorial on using the MIT App Inventor 2 to develop Android apps.



According to the latest IDC report, vendors shipped a total of 334.4 million smartphones worldwide in the first quarter of 2015. Android dominated the market with a 78 per cent share during this period. Every single day, approximately 1.5 million new Android devices get activated. By June 2013, there were 50 billion cumulative app downloads from Google Play Store. Estimates indicate that Google made app payouts to the tune of US\$ 3 billion in 2014. If you are not a core programmer but still want to develop Android applications or just want to know how to develop Android apps, this column will help you. One of the platforms designed for developing Android apps, with an easy GUI based builder, is the MIT App Inventor 2 (MIT AI 2). It should be noted here that App Inventor is only one of 20 third party tools listed in Wikipedia for Android development. The following statistics indicate its popularity.

MIT App Inventor supports a worldwide community of nearly 3 million users representing 195 countries worldwide. The tool's 100,000 active weekly users have built more than 7 million Android apps.

In this column, we will get familiar with the basic App

Inventor GUI and get started by building upon a simple app called TalkToMe, which is one of the tutorial apps available from MIT AI 2. We will build upon the same app to create another app called GreetMe, with which we will learn some basic logic and block-building work, including usage of variables.

Some history about the MIT App Inventor

There is interesting history behind App Inventor as you will find in the related entries in Wikipedia. With Google's support, MIT made its first version available as MIT App Inventor (classic) in March 2012. The latest version is called MIT App Inventor 2, and was made available to developers by MIT in December 2013. The major difference is that App Inventor 2 now runs entirely from the browser. There have also been numerous improvements to the user experience, as well as aesthetic alterations.

Getting started with MIT App Inventor 2

Since the MIT App Inventor is cloud based, you need to first navigate to the AI 2 link in the Web browser.